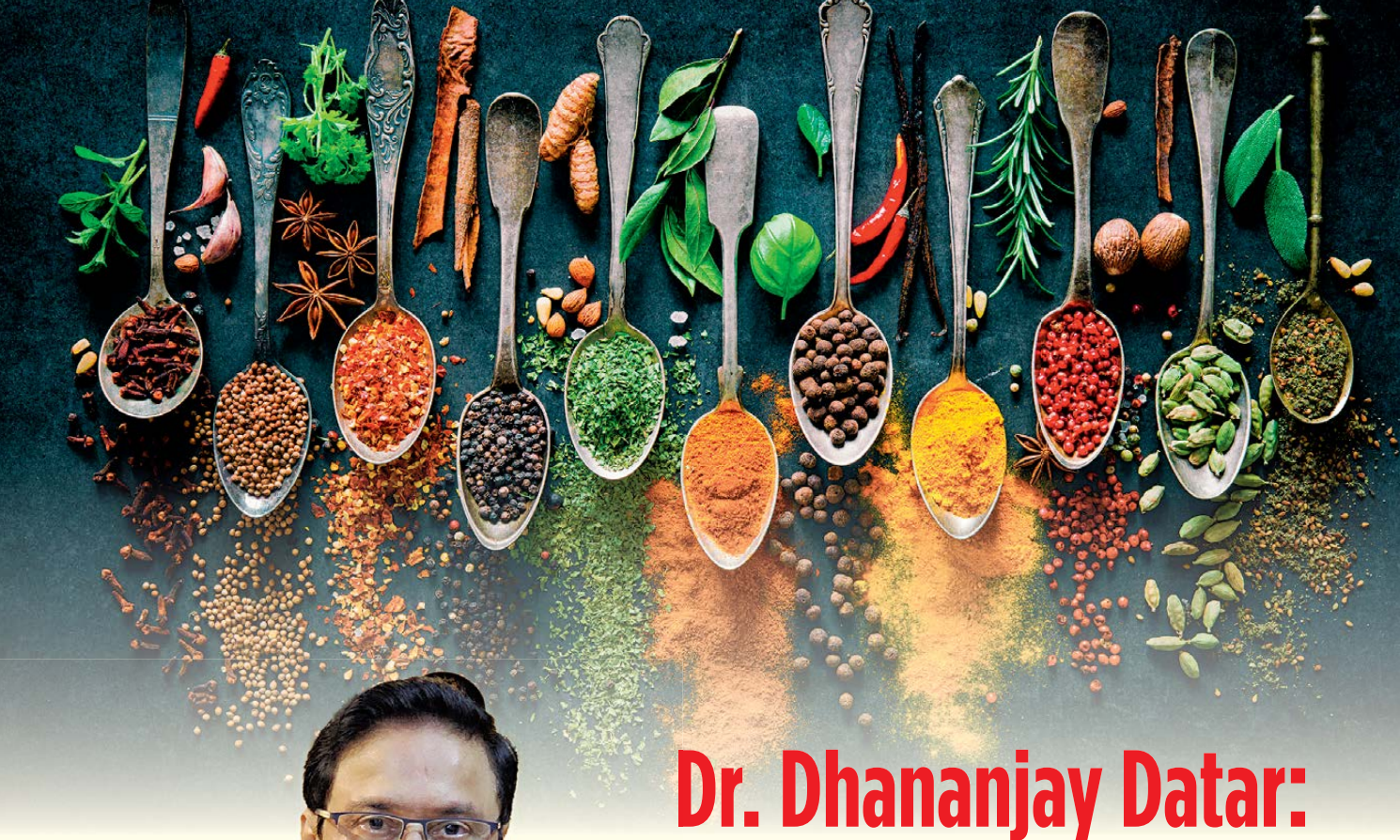


Dr. Dhananjay Datar: The Maharajah of Spices

Explorers from across the globe spent their lifetimes searching for India, the land of the mystical spices. Today an Indian is truly ruling the roost, offering the best of spices across the GCC and Asia. Dr. Dhananjay Datar is the 14th richest Indian in the Gulf.



DHANANJAY DATAR,
CMD Adil Trading LLC, Dubai

If there ever was a rags to riches story, it is Dhananjay's. He was so poor he couldn't afford a bicycle and dream of nothing more than a square meal. Today, as the Chairman & Managing Director of the Adil Trading, UAE he is driven around in a bespoke Rolls-Royce.

Dhananjay's story is that of perseverance triumphing over all odds. He inherited a fledgling business from his father and literally gave it wings. It has been almost 30 years since the Late Mahadeo Datar opened his store in the UAE. Today, the Adil Group of grocery shops has acquired a cult status among Indian expatriates with over 8000 varieties of authentic Indian foods, including spices, pickles and pappadams, serving them from 50 branches across UAE.

Dhananjay was born in a middle-class Maharashtrian family from Vidarbha. The realities of life taught him the values of self-reliance, frugality and hard work. They instilled in him an indomitable spirit to fight against all odds to emerge victorious. Fiercely independent, he used to go from door to door selling phenyl and instant mixes to fund his education.

Dhananjay Datar came to Dubai as a 20-year-old in 1984 to join his late father in setting up a small shop in the crowded alleys of Bur Dubai to sell Indian spices and condiments. Mahadeo